

Finger Millet

Finger millet (*Eleusine Coracana*) is a traditional grain that is popular in Sri Lanka because of its nutritional value. It is called Kurakkan in Sinhala and Tamil. Vitamin B, iron and calcium are all present in abundance in finger millet. It is also rich in dietary fibre and helps in easy digestion. Therefore it is an excellent remedy for constipation as it acts as a natural laxative. It is low in fat content but rich in carbohydrates which makes it good for people who are overweight. The digestion process of finger millet is slow and therefore

helps in keeping the blood sugar at a low level. As a result, it has become a favourite food among diabetic patients. This wholesome grain is made into porridge, idli, pittu, rotti, hoppers and bread in various regions. It is increasingly becoming popular as a bakery product and recently its demand has increased considerably as people have become aware of its health benefits. Organically grown finger millet is healthier and safer to eat as there are no harmful chemicals used in growing it.

In Sri Lanka, it is grown in Anuradapura, Kegalle Moneragala, Hambantota, Ratnapura, Nuwara Eliya, Ampara, Badulla and Jaffna districts. It is a hardy crop that is well adapted to arid highland areas in Africa and Asia. The crop is now grown on a larger scale in India. It grows best in an environment with medium rainfall, an annual temperature range of 11°C to 27°C and a soil of pH range of 5.0 to 8.2. It is a crop that has great potential if promoted as a healthy food.

Activity 01

Reading and Writing

Match the following words with their meanings according to the context. Then do activities 01 and 02 in your workbook using those words.

Words

- potential
- digestion
- abundance
- wholesome
- laxative
- hardy
- remedy
- arid

Meanings

- quantity more than enough
- healthy
- capacity for development
- medicine, application or treatment
- enduring difficult conditions
- very dry
- the process by which food is converted into substances
- a substance that helps digestion and prevents constipation

Activity 02

Read the passage on finger millet and fill in the grid.

Finger Millet	
Areas where it is grown in Sri Lanka	
Nutrients	
Benefits	
Food items that can be prepared	
Required rainfall	
Required temperature	
Required type of soil	

Activity 03

Answer the following questions.

1. Which substance in finger millet helps easy digestion?
2. What makes it good for people who are overweight?
3. Why has the demand for finger millet increased recently?
4. Why is finger millet a favourite food among diabetic patients?
5. Why is organically grown finger millet safer to eat?
6. Describe the environmental conditions required for growing finger millet.

Activity 04

Study the grid and write a paragraph about rice. Then find similar information about Green Gram and fill in the grid given in your workbook activity 03.

Rice	
Areas where it is mostly grown in Sri Lanka	Kurunegala, Ampara, Anuradapura, Polonnaruwa
Nutrients	Carbohydrates, fat, dietary fibre, vitamin B
Benefits	Used as the staple foods
Food items that can be prepared	String hoppers, hoppers, pittu, rotti
Required rainfall	About 1900 mm
Required temperature	21° C to 32°C.
Required soil	pH range of 5.0-8.0

Activity 05

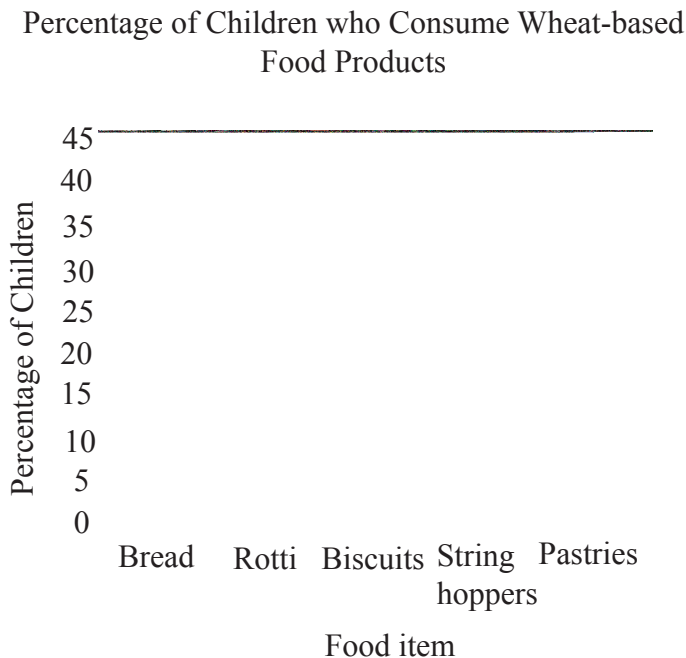
Speaking

Work in small groups. List the advantages of eating homemade food. Present your list to the class.

Activity 06

Writing

The following bar graph shows the percentages of children who consume wheat-based food in an urban area. Study the graph and write a description of it.



Include the following information.

- What does the graph represents
- What information is given in the horizontal axis
- What information is given in the vertical axis
- What is the most eaten wheat-based food
- What is the least eaten wheat-based food

You may use the following words;

Less least many more most equal

Using the paragraph you have written as a model, describe the pie chart given in your workbook activity 05 about favourite food items among grade ten students of your school.

Activity 07

Listening and Writing

Here is a recipe for preparing Kurakkan pittu. Listen to the interview between a chef and a presenter of a radio programme and fill in the missing information.

Kurakkan Pittu

Ingredients

1.
2.
3.

Method

- 1) Put the flour in a clay bowl.
- 2) Sprinkle a little..... and salt and start mixing the flour.
- 3) Add water as you mix the flour.
- 4) Move the hand in a circular movement.
- 5) Continue this for a minutes.
- 6) Afterwards, pour some water into another clay pot and tie a cleancovering the mouth.
- 7) Put the pittu dough on top of the cloth.
- 8) Then cover the dough with another pot.
- 9) Now put the pot on

Pittu will be ready within half an hour.

Learning Point

Connectives

Study the sentences given below. Note how the connectives in bold are used to join two ideas.

- 1) Singithi likes to have rice for breakfast **while** her brother likes string
hoppers.
While Singithi's brother likes to have string hoppes for breakfast, she
likes to have rice.
- 2) Breakfast is the most important meal of the day **although** many people
skip it.
Although many people skip breakfast, it is the most important meal of
the day.
- 3) Mrs. Perera enjoys preparing pittu **even though** it takes time.
Even though it takes time, Mrs. Perera enjoys preparing pittu.
- 4) I do not know how to prepare laddu **though** I have tasted it.
Though I have tasted laddu, I do not know how to prepare it .
- 5) Some people still prefer to eat fast food **in spite of** its health risks.
In spite of its health risks some people still prefer to eat fast food.
- 6) **Whenever** Riyaza goes to the market with her mother, she likes to buy
manioc.
Riyaza likes to buy manioc, **whenever** she goes to the market with her
mother.

Activity 08

Fill in the blanks with a suitable connective from the given list.

in spite of, although, even though, whenever, while

1. I could not find the tin opener I searched everywhere in
the kitchen.
2. Mrs. Perera visits the nearby fair to buy vegetables.....
she has time to spare.

3. Everyone enjoyed the meal the bad cooking.
- 4..... I have heard about Italian food, I have not tasted it yet.
5. Kumaran ordered dosai Thanusha decided to have noodles.

Activity 09

Join the following pairs of sentences using a suitable connective. Make any changes that are necessary.

1. It is difficult to prepare watalappan.
Most people enjoy eating it.
2. Some people still prefer to eat it.
There is little nutritional value in fast food.
3. Mother prepared dinner.
Father laid the table.
4. We enjoyed our food.
We were not hungry.
5. My mother prepares food using finger millet.
She has some free time.

Pronunciation

Activity 10

Speaking

Read the following sentences aloud.

1. Do not spill food.
2. Do you think it is polite to talk with your mouth full?
3. Do not make any noise while you eating.
4. Do not pass cutlery pointing it at the other person.
5. Do not serve yourself more than what you can eat.

6. Food is served in buffet on some occasions.
7. I had rotti and hoppes for breakfast.
8. Pizza is an Italian food.
9. Eating junk food is bad for your health, isn't it?
10. Most people prefer tea to coffee.

Learning Point

Irregular Plurals

A large majority of nouns in the English language are pluralized by adding an 's' or 'es' to the end of the word. They are called regular plurals. Nouns that do not follow the above rule are called irregular plurals.

Some foreign words form their plurals in the following way.

<u>Singular</u>	<u>Plural</u>
syllabus	syllabi
axis	axes
criterion	criteria
index	indices/indexes
medium	media
curriculum	curricula
formula	formulae/formulas

Some compound nouns form their plurals in the following way.

<u>Singular</u>	<u>Plural</u>
spoonful	spoonfuls
passer-by	passers-by
by-way	by-ways
guest-of-honour	guests-of-honour

Activity 11

Writing

Write the plural form of the following irregular nouns.

Singular

Plural

fungus	
phenomenon	
bacterium	
nucleus	
analysis	
appendix	
vertebra	

Activity 12

Form the plurals.

Singular

Plural

father- in-law	fathers- in- law
sister- in- law	
teacher- in –charge	
a ten-year-old	
notary public	
passer- by	
commander-in-chief	
guest- of –honour	